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KUMAR MANGALAM BIRLA, 55

CHAIRMAN, ADITYA BIRLA GROUP



THE EMPIRE BUILDER

BECAUSE in his cool, unflappable manner, Birla plays a long game. No wonder, his group's turnover catapulted to nearly Rs 5 lakh crore last year, making it one of India's largest conglomerates

BECAUSE he continues to take India to the world. His metals business announced a $2.5 bn (or Rs 20,706 crore) investment in a greenfield aluminium rolling and recycling plant in Alabama, US, the biggest such by an Indian business group in the US

BECAUSE his cement flagship UltraTech created history when its sales volumes topped 100 million tonnes (mt) in FY23, greater than the next three companies (Ambuja, ACC and Shree) combined

PREPARING GEN-NEXT **Birla has now formally inducted his children, Ananya and Aryaman, into the group, making them the fifth generation of entrepreneurs in the iconic family**

TOP HONOUR **Was conferred the Padma Bhushan, India's third-highest civilian honour, in March, becoming the fourth member of the Birla family to receive the Padma Award**

BECAUSE his fashion business will soon have a portfolio of the best Indian ethnic brands—Sabyasachi, Tarun Tahiliani, Shantnu & Nikhil, Masaba, Jaypore, Tasva, W, Aurelia, the last two with the acquisition of TCNS Clothing

BECAUSE if the BITS School of Management in 2021 enhanced the old tech-ed brand's scope, this year, it gave India a legal nursery with BITS Law School, Mumbai

BECAUSE he set up a £15 million scholarship programme at the London Business School in memory of his grandfather B.K. Birla—the largest endowed scholarship gift to a European business school

BECAUSE he has set up the Aditya Birla Centre for Community Initiatives & Rural Development to implement programmes for rural upliftment

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**